for the state in the economy in some areas and increased role for it in some other areas. The re-definition of the state's role in the economy (though it was the contemporary thinking world wide) made most of the experts and the business community to conclude as if there will be no role for planning in the economy. The New Economic Policy (NEP) of 1991–92 was a prima-facie proposal for the expansion of the market economy in the country. But it was not the case altogether. The planning has not become irrelevant though it needed to search for a new orientation. And it was highly essential that the process of planning keeps its relevance to the bigger and the broader process of economic reforms. This particular new function of the PC must be seen in this light.

(ii) To monitor the progress of various Central Ministries. It should be noted here that for the first time, the PC went to set the 'monitorable targets' for ten areas indicating development. The Central Ministries have been linked to these monitorable targets. The timely performances of the Ministries are now monitored by the PC as per its new fuction.

With the inclusion of the above-mentioned two functions in the existing functions (which were already very broad), the PC has emerged as a real 'supercabinet'. Since it is basically the Deputy-Chairman who officiates the general meetings of the commission, he has a high-level say[55] in articulating the direction and the nature of the economic policies. Through the first new function it articulates the future dimensions of the economic reforms and through the second new function, it influences the works of the various Ministries—ultimately it seems as if the PC has been able to emerge as the real think-tank of development in the country.[56]

The PC has also been able to influence the states economic policies since 2002 in a great way. Though the PC today does not make the state plans[57] it is able to influence the overall economic policies of the states. It has been possible due to the setting of 'monitorable targets' for states for the same development indicators/areas as has been set for the Centre.[58] The states are liable for being monitored by the PC concerning their performances regarding these monitorable targets. This way the Central Government has started having its say over the state governments via the new functions of the PC.